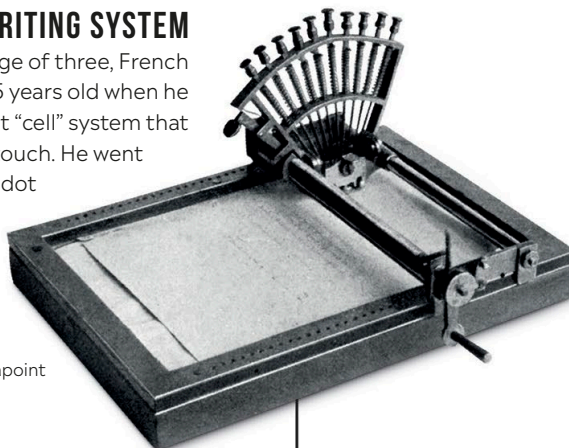


1829

## LOUIS BRAILLE PUBLISHES HIS RAISED DOT WRITING SYSTEM

Blinded in an accident at the age of three, French inventor Louis Braille was just 15 years old when he began developing his six-dot “cell” system that enabled the blind to read by touch. He went on to invent Decapoint, a 100-dot system by which the blind could write to sighted people.

▷ Foucault apparatus for printing Decapoint

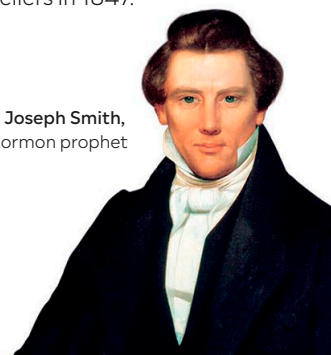


1830

## BOOK OF MORMON PUBLISHED

At the age of 24, the American religious leader Joseph Smith published what he claimed to be a history of an ancient American civilization revealed to him by an angel – the *Book of Mormon*. Smith's new religion, Mormonism, attracted thousands of followers, many of whom moved to Utah to found a society based on their beliefs in 1847.

▷ Joseph Smith, Mormon prophet



1825

**1825 The Java War**, a guerrilla war against the colonial Dutch empire, claims 200,000 lives over five years

**1830 The French invade** the Ottoman Regency of Algiers; fighting continues until 1847

**1828 Queen Ranavalona I** of Madagascar (r. 1828-1861) begins a brutal reign in which half the population perishes



△ Niépce's camera

1826

## THE FIRST PHOTOGRAPHS

French inventor Joseph Nicéphore Niépce captured the earliest surviving photograph using his heliography (“sun writing”) technique, in which a plate coated with light-sensitive bitumen was left in a camera obscura for several days to produce an image. Louis Daguerre refined the process and was credited with the invention of photography until Niépce's photograph *View from the Window at Le Gras* was rediscovered in 1952.

◁ *View from the Window at Le Gras*, the earliest surviving photograph of a real-world scene